

Cloud Storage ASO Playbook

Live-scraped competitive research for a new cloud storage / vault / backup app — who ranks on the generic keywords, which keywords a no-brand app can actually win, and the exact listing to ship.

35 search queries scraped

304 apps detailed

243 non-brand · 61 brand

0 fetch failures

The verdict: brands (Drive, Photos, Dropbox, TeraBox, MEGA) permanently own ranks #1–3 on every head term — but the top-10 is genuinely winnable. Apps with only **24K–513K installs** hold top-10 slots on “cloud storage”, “cloud backup” and “phone backup” today, and the #1 result for “cloud backup” is a 269K-install app released Dec 2024. Position as a **generic cloud drive + privacy skin + phone-backup keyword set**, launch on the wide-open long tail, and climb the ladder below.

8/10

non-brand apps in the top-10
for “secure cloud”

#1

rank on “cloud backup” held
by a 269K-install app

1.24B

median top-10 installs on
“phone backup” (volume
proxy)

5

distinct niches mapped
among non-brand winners

Five niches, one opening

Every non-brand winner fits one of five plays. Saturation is judged against observed demand (volume proxy) and how small the apps cracking the top-10 are.

NICHE	EXEMPLARS (INSTALLS)	READ
Generic cloud drive <i>medium</i>	Icedrive 404K · MobiDrive 1.6M · Total Drive 513K · S3Drive 34K	Brands take #1–5, but sub-550K apps sit top-10 on “cloud storage” — winnable via keywords.
Privacy / encrypted cloud <i>low saturation</i>	Ente 167K · NordLocker 31K · Cloud Secure 11K · Filen 86K	“secure cloud” top-10 has eight non-brands, incl. an 11K app at #2. Smaller demand, strong conversion angle.
Phone data backup <i>least saturated vs demand</i>	G Cloud 8.5M · Swift Backup 918K · Phone Backup 156K · Cloud Backup & Data Restore 24K	Huge SERP volume, yet a 156K app holds #3 on “phone backup”. Fastest keyword ROI observed.
Free-up-space / cleaner <i>funded UA machines</i>	Cleanup 28M (Nov 2025!) · Phone Cleaner AI 96M	High demand and winnability, but competitors are ad-driven UA machines. Secondary angle only.
Photo vault / hide photos <i>adjacent intent</i>	Vaulty 12M · LockMyPix 17M	Intent is <i>hiding</i> , not storing. Cover with “vault” wording; don’t pivot into it.

Top non-branded rankers

Top 20 of the 50-app tracked set, ranked by keyword visibility (full data in competitors_top50.csv). These are the apps proving generic keywords convert to installs without a brand.

#	APP	INSTALLS	RATING	SINCE	CORE KEYWORD RANKS
1	S3Drive: Cloud storage	34K	4.06	2022	private cloud #2 · cloud space #5 · cloud storage #6 · file storage #6
2	Total Drive – Cloud Storage	513K	3.59	2024	data drive #1 · drive storage #6 · online storage #9 · cloud storage #10
3	Icedrive: Secure Cloud Storage	404K	4.21	2019	safe storage #4 · secure cloud #5 · free cloud storage #10
4	MobiDrive Cloud Storage & Sync	1.6M	4.19	2021	cloud drive #5 · cloud space #7 · unlimited storage #8
5	Ente Photos – Encrypted Backup	167K	4.31	2020	photo backup #4 · gallery backup #5 · cloud photos #8
6	Swift Backup	918K	3.61	2017	backup app #2 · data backup #4 · whatsapp backup #6 · phone backup #10
7	Cloud Backup and Data Restore	24K	4.22	2026	data backup #5 · backup app #7 · cloud backup #10 — live 4 months
8	SMS Backup & Restore	40M	3.84	2009	phone backup #6 · contacts backup #7
9	MobiSaver: Data & Photo Recovery	19M	2.08	2017	data backup #7 · video backup #9
10	Cleanup: Phone Storage Cleaner	28M	4.43	2025	free up space #2 · storage cleaner #5
11	Autosync – File Sync & Backup	397K	4.65	2021	data backup #6 · backup app #8
12	Phone Backup	156K	3.97	2020	phone backup #3 · contacts

(JR Beetroots)					backup #10
13	Ultimate Backup	25K	3.75	2022	unlimited storage #4
14	G Cloud Backup	8.5M	4.42	2012	cloud vault #7
15	Cx File Explorer	47M	4.76	2018	file storage #7 · document storage #8 · cloud file manager #8
16	Solid Explorer File Manager	14M	4.46	2015	cloud file manager #2 · file storage #9
17	Storage Cleaner: Cleanup Phone	559K	4.84	2026	storage cleaner #3 · free up space #5
18	Easy Contacts Backup & Restore	3.9M	4.43	2014	contacts backup #2
19	FamilyAlbum – Photo Sharing	16M	4.83	2015	photo storage #10
20	Phone Cleaner – AI Cleaner	96M	4.76	2023	storage cleaner #2 · free up space #4

Brand wall for reference: Google Drive 14.4B · Google Photos 14.5B · Files by Google 7.8B · OneDrive 6.0B · Dropbox 1.2B · TeraBox 444M · MEGA 191M. They hold #1–3 on every head term; the fight is #4–10.

03 · KEYWORDS

Keyword opportunity board

Winnability = non-brand apps in the live top-10. Volume proxy = median installs of the top-10 (relative demand, not absolute search volume — we scrape live SERPs instead of paid-tool estimates). Evidence names the within-reach apps ranking today.

KEYWORD	WINNABLE	VOL. PROXY	EVIDENCE IN TOP-10
phone backup	5/10	1.24B	Phone Backup #3 (156K) · Swift Backup #10 (918K)

free up space	6/10	95M	Cleanup #2 (28M) · Storage Cleaner #5 (559K)
data backup	5/10	81M	Swift #4 (918K) · Cloud Backup & Data Restore #5 (24K)
secure cloud	8/10	404K	Cloud Secure #2 (11K) · Icedrive #5 (404K) · Jottacloud #7 (172K)
private cloud	6/10	3.2M	S3Drive #2 (34K) · NordLocker #6 (31K)
cloud space	5/10	5.8M	CloudSpace #4 (14K) · S3Drive #5 (34K) · MobiDrive #7 (1.6M)
cloud vault	4/10	51M	BoultBox #4 (5K) · G Cloud #7 (8.5M) · S3Drive #9 (34K)
free up phone storage	5/10	28M	Storage Cleaner #3 (559K) · Clean Now #7 (437K)
cloud file manager	4/10	47M	Solid Explorer #2 (14M) · Cloud File Manager #9 (224K)
cloud backup	2/10	444M	Cloud Backup and Restore #1 (269K) · 24K app at #10
cloud storage	2/10	444M	S3Drive #6 (34K) · Total Drive #10 (513K)
cloud drive	3/10	49M	MobiDrive #5 (1.6M) · S3Drive #7 (34K)
video backup	3/10	444M	S3Drive #6 (34K) · Photo & Video Storage Backup #7 (41K)
file storage	3/10	1.24B	S3Drive #6 (34K) · Cx File Explorer #7 (47M)
drive storage	3/10	1.24B	Total Drive #6 (513K) · S3Drive #9 (34K)
backup photos and videos	2/10	444M	Ente #5 (167K)
contacts backup	9/10	319K	Easy Contacts Backup #2 (3.9M) — needs the feature built

whatsapp backup	9/10	918K	Tiny apps at #1/#5/#7 — wide open, needs the feature + risky permissions
unlimited storage	policy risk	1.6M	UnLim #1 (1.2M) — misleading-claims magnet, target via honest phrasing only
photo storage	2/10	91M	Google/Amazon own it; Gallery #9 (31M) is the floor
my cloud · data drive	skip	—	WD-brand junk / off-intent SERPs (truckers, data usage)

04 · THE LISTING

Proposed ASO package

Three policy-safe title options (≤30 chars, keyword-first, no emoji/caps/superlatives). Pair title 1 with short description 2 so title + short together cover eight primary keywords without repetition.

OPTION 1 · RECOMMENDED

Cloud Storage - Photo Backup
28 / 30 chars
Head term first + strongest niche pair. Mirrors the S3Drive / Total Drive pattern that ranks fastest at zero brand equity.

OPTION 2

Cloud Drive: Secure File Vault
30 / 30 chars
Head term + privacy niche — “secure” and “vault” both evidenced winnable long-tail.

OPTION 3

Phone Backup - Cloud Storage
28 / 30 chars
Leads the single highest-opportunity keyword (winnability 5, volume 1.24B) and keeps the head term.



Cloud Storage - Photo Backup

Your Studio · Productivity · Free, subscription IAP, no ads

SHORT DESCRIPTION · 78/80

Backup your phone to a private cloud — restore files anytime, free up storage.

Running out of space? Move your photos, videos and files to secure cloud storage and free up space on your phone in minutes. Sign up and get free cloud storage instantly — automatic photo backup, a private file vault and easy sharing, all in one simple cloud drive.

WHY [APP NAME]?

Your phone is not a safe place for your memories. Phones get lost, broken and stolen — your cloud backup doesn't. [App name] keeps every photo, video and document safe online and within reach on any device.

AUTOMATIC PHOTO & VIDEO BACKUP

- Back up photos and videos automatically in the background
- Original quality — no compression, no stripped metadata
- Never lose a memory again, even if you lose your phone
- Free up storage space with one tap once your gallery backup is complete

SECURE CLOUD DRIVE FOR ALL YOUR FILES

- Upload documents, music, PDFs and any file type to your online drive

~3,400 chars · primary phrases at ~2–2.5% density, each in natural sentence context

— below Google's keyword-stuffing threshold. Alternate short description (80/80):

"Free up space: auto backup photos & videos to a safe online drive. Sync & share."

Category: **Productivity** · Tags: Cloud Storage, Backup & Restore, File Sharing, Photo & Video, File Manager · Monetization: subscription tiers (100GB/1TB/2TB), **no ads** (0 of the top-7 cloud drives run ads) · Free GB quota is table stakes — every winner leads with 5–20GB free.

05 · ROADMAP

Launch keyword ladder

Start where 5K–34K-install apps rank top-5 today; graduate as installs compound.

Re-scrape monthly (the scraper is cached and re-runs in minutes) and

promote/demote keywords between title, short and long description by observed movement.

Phase 0

launch → 10K

secure cloud storage · private cloud storage · cloud vault · cloud space · data backup · backup app

Proof: 5K–34K-install apps hold top-5 on all of these right now.

Phase 1

10K → 100K

phone backup · cloud backup · video backup · backup photos and videos · free up phone storage

Proof: 24K–160K-install apps sit top-10 on each.

Phase 2

100K → 1M

cloud storage app · free cloud storage · cloud drive · file storage · drive storage

Proof: 34K–513K-install apps already top-10.

Phase 3

1M+

cloud storage · photo storage · online storage

Contest ranks #4–6 behind the permanent brand wall; expand locales with translated listings + custom store listings (IN, BR, ID, MX first).

06 · BEST PRACTICES

What the industry says (2025–26)

TITLE · 30 CHARS

Heaviest-weighted text field. Lead with the highest-volume keyword — for a no-brand app, the generic term goes first.

[AppTweak](#) · [AppRadar](#)

SHORT DESCRIPTION · 80 CHARS

Indexed, second-strongest field. Use complementary keywords not already in the title, phrased as a conversion message.

[AppTweak](#)

LONG DESCRIPTION · 4,000 CHARS

Fully indexed — Play has no hidden keyword field. Primary keywords at 2–3% density, front-loaded into the first paragraph, headers and bullet starts; stay at the low end.

METADATA POLICY (2024+)

No emoji, ALL CAPS, “#1 / best” claims, or promo text in titles; no keyword stuffing anywhere. All three proposed titles comply.

[Google Play policy](#)

